

BRAND GUIDELINES DOCUMENT



What is this document?

Welcome to the **Black Youth Empowerment Network** Visual Brand Guidelines. This document is designed for graphic designers, web designers, social media managers, and any partners responsible for creating or managing brand communications.

Within these guidelines, you'll find clear direction on the correct usage of our logo, color palette, typography, and overall visual language. These standards exist to ensure consistency across all touchpoints and to maintain a cohesive, recognisable brand presence.

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BRAND STRATEGY

1.1 Our Mission

BYEN connects Black youth to opportunities, resources, and a supportive community, strengthening their personal and professional development and equipping them to create meaningful change.

1.2 Our Vision

A future where Black youth are fully supported in becoming leaders who thrive professionally, socially, intellectually, and beyond.

1.3 Tagline

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur. Excepteur sint occaecat cupidatat non proident, sunt in culpa qui officia deserunt mollit anim id est laborum.

Building America’s Network of Young Black Leaders

1.4 Brand Positioning

BYEN is a community of advocates, changemakers, and trailblazers united not by status or title, but by a shared energy for change, growth, and leadership — a home for young Black people ready to build, lead, and push their communities forward.

BRAND VOICE

2.1 Brand Tone

BYEN should feel powerful, youthful, and serious about impact — while staying rooted in the warmth, fellowship, and cultural energy that make it more than jus another network, but a genuine community of Black leaders showing up for one another.

Direct & Jargon Free

BYEN's audience spans 16-year-old students, corporate partners, and foundation funders; and the brand has to speak fluently to all three. Clarity is respect. If a student's grandmother can't understand what BYEN does from the website homepage, the copy needs to be rewritten.

Warm, but not soft

BYEN cares deeply about the communities it serves and that care should be felt in every word. But warmth without edge reads as charity (or a community service org), and BYEN is not either. It's a builder. The tone should feel like a trusted mentor who believes in you completely and also tells you the truth: encouraging, real, and never condescending.

Precise & Evidence-led

Every claim BYEN makes in its brand voice should be traceable to something real. Not "we transform communities" but "40 students placed, \$75K awarded, 3 counties served." This precision builds trust with funders, credibility with corporate partners, and confidence with youth who need to know BYEN actually delivers. The tone is never vague. It never hides behind feel-good language when a number or a specific outcome would be more powerful.

Aspirational, yet Grounded

BYEN's tone should make Black youth feel like the future belongs to them — while also acknowledging the very real barriers standing between them and opportunity. The brand doesn't pretend the world is fair. It says: "We know it isn't, and here's exactly what we're going to do about it." This balance is critical. Too aspirational and the brand feels out of touch. Too focused on barriers and it becomes heavy.

2.2 Our Brand Pillars



IMPACT

Impact is the difference between good intentions and real change — it's proof that effort translates into results people can see and feel. Without a clear, measurable impact, purpose risks becoming just a promise instead of a reality.

2.2 Our Brand Pillars



COLLABORATION

No meaningful progress happens in isolation — collaboration is what transforms individual effort into collective impact. It builds trust across differences and ensures that solutions reflect the needs of everyone they're meant to serve.

2.2 Our Brand Pillars



LEADERSHIP

Leadership is the foundation for lasting change — without it, good ideas stall and communities lose momentum. It's what turns potential into direction, and individuals into people others can trust and follow.

LOGO

3.1 Symbol

This is our brand symbol, our core signifier. This fist of solidarity, advocacy and community represents our brand and who we are. Our symbol should be the main logo used wherever BYEN is represented. Where our wordmark and lockup cannot fit.

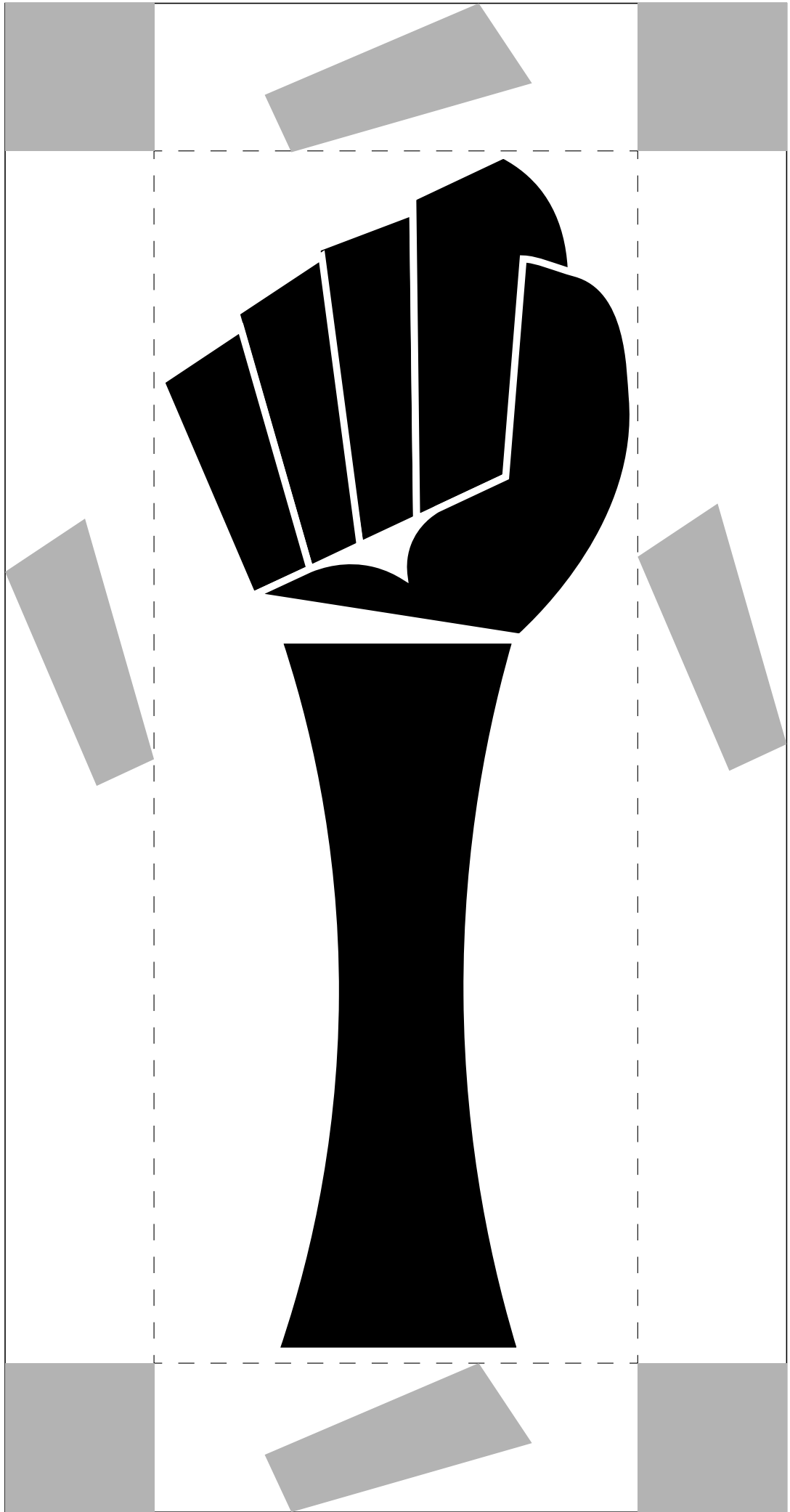
Examples of best use: favicons, merchandise, social media...

Our symbol can be used on both light and dark backgrounds. On dark backgrounds the inverted MUST be used. If the regualr logo is used on a dark background, the logo becomes hard to read.



3.2 Clearspace

To maintain the integrity of our logo, it's essential to provide adequate clearspace around it. This clearspace is determined by the dimensions of the symbol itself, which should be repeated around the logo to establish a consistent boundary. Avoid placing any graphics or text within this area. When positioning the logo near the edge of a canvas, ensure that the clearspace extends sufficiently to create a visual buffer from the edge.



BLACK YOUTH EMPOWERMENT NETWORK

Logo

3.3 Wordmark

Our wordmark uses the Froople typeface in uppercase selected to complement the ligatures and line weights of the symbol. This deliberate choice creates strong visual harmony between the wordmark and the icon.

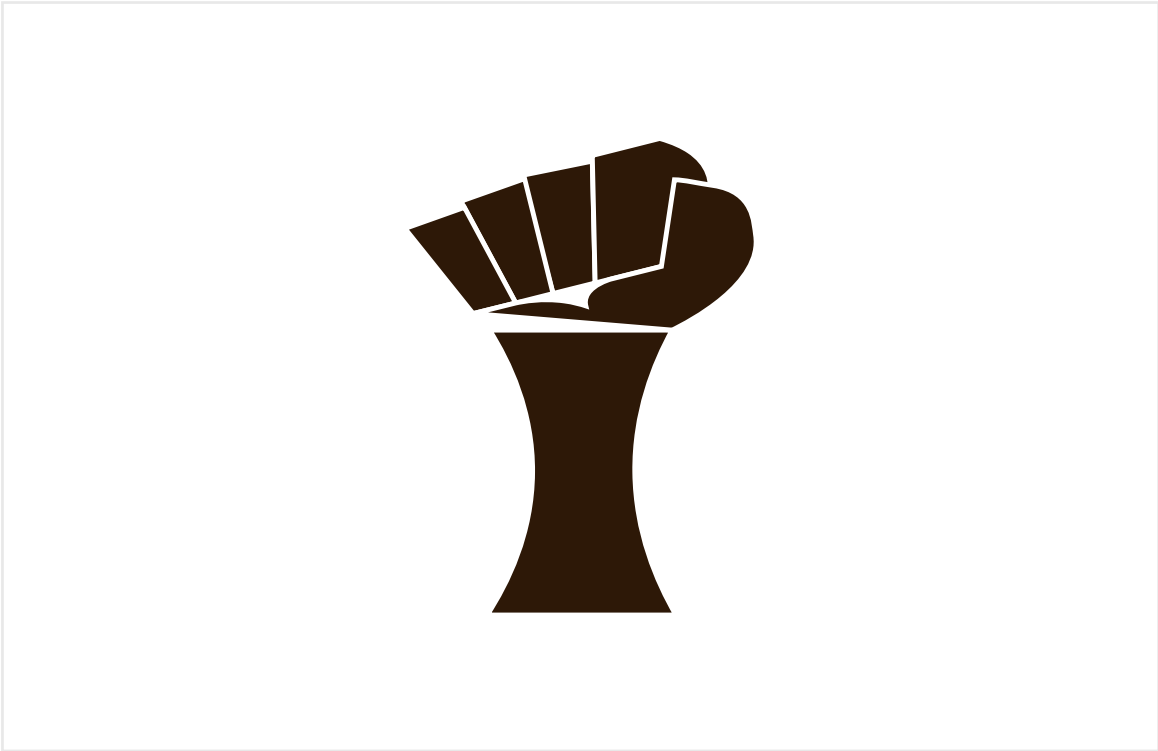
3.4 Logo Dont's

Protecting the integrity of our logo is essential to maintaining a strong, consistent, and recognizable brand. The logo is a visual shortcut to who we are—when it's altered or misused, it weakens trust, reduces legibility, and dilutes brand equity.

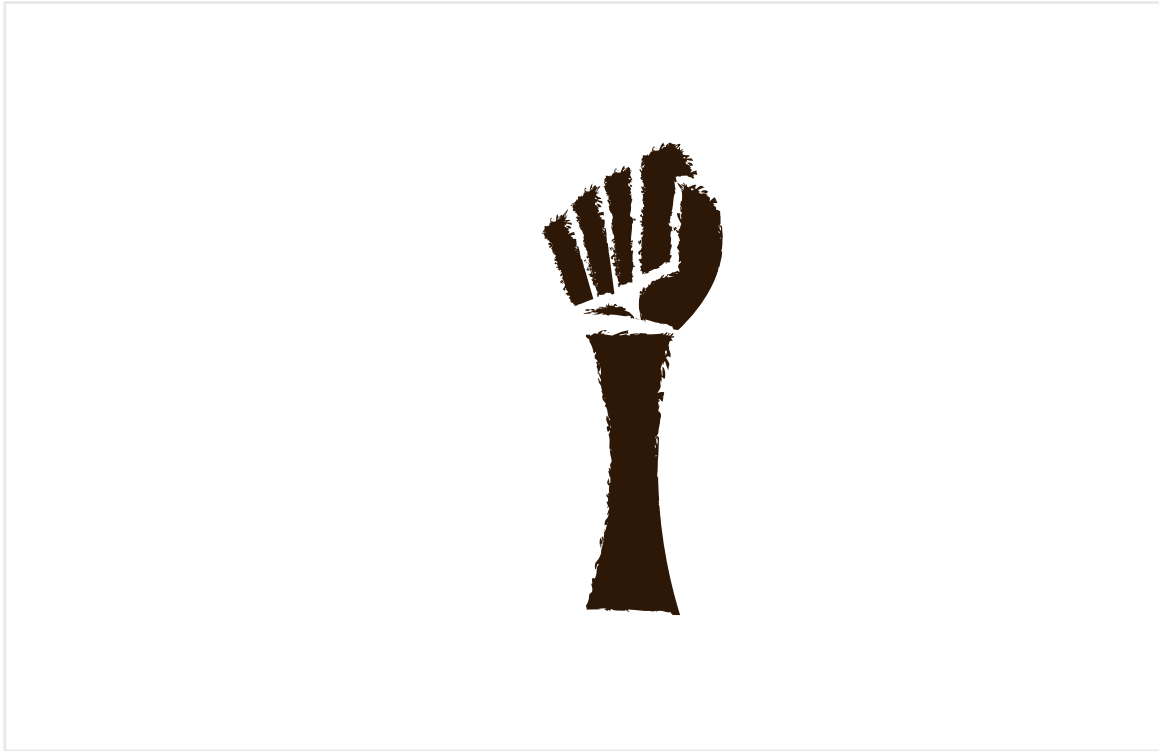
Do Not Rotate Our Logo



Do Not Skew Our Logo



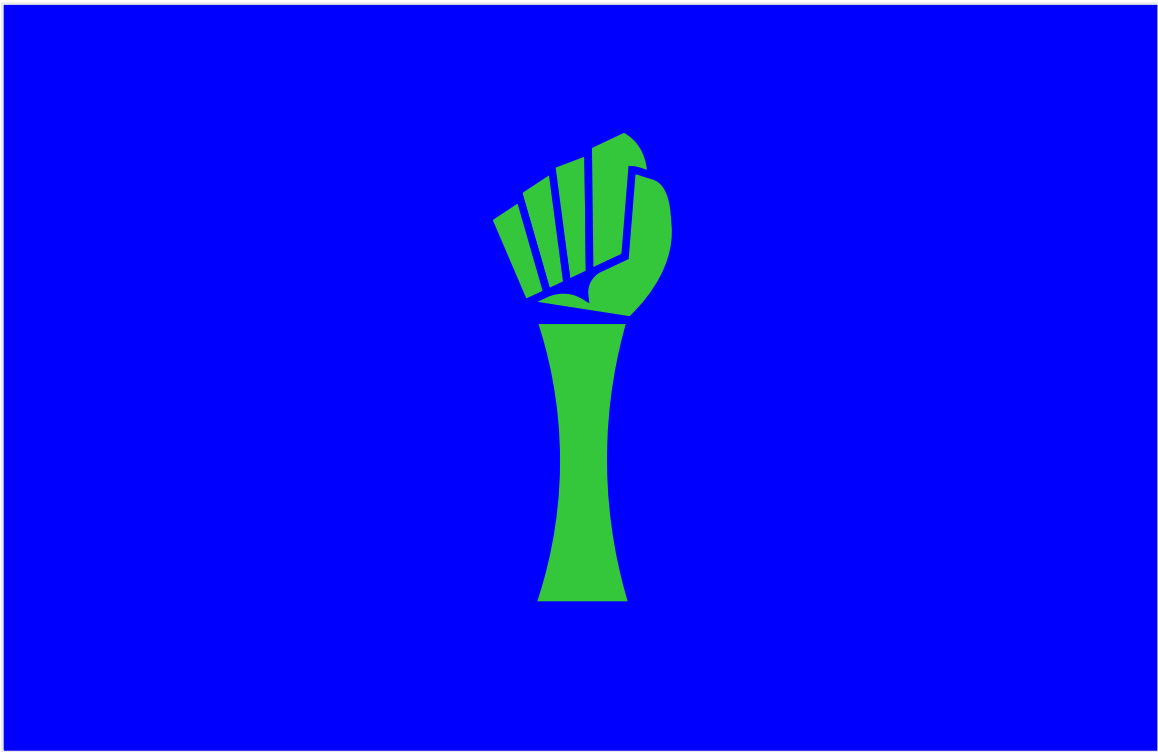
Do Not Add Effects to Our Logo



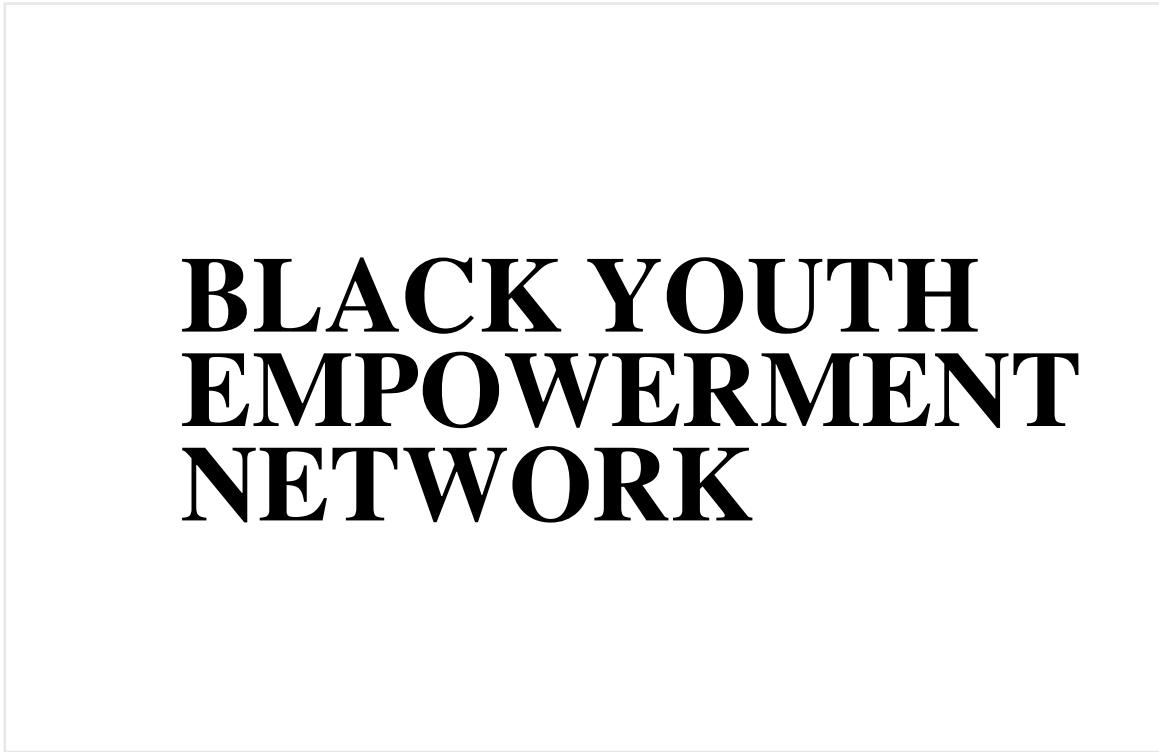
Do Not Gradient our Logo



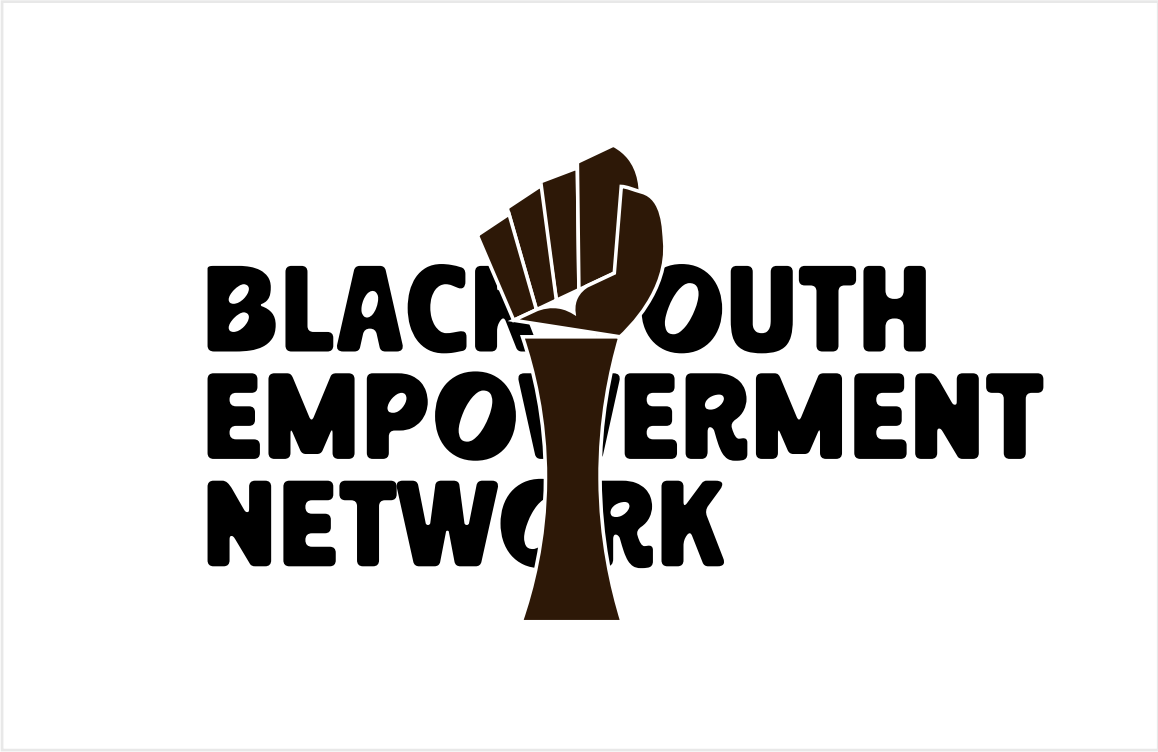
Do Not add the logo to a High Contrast Background



Do not change the font of our logo



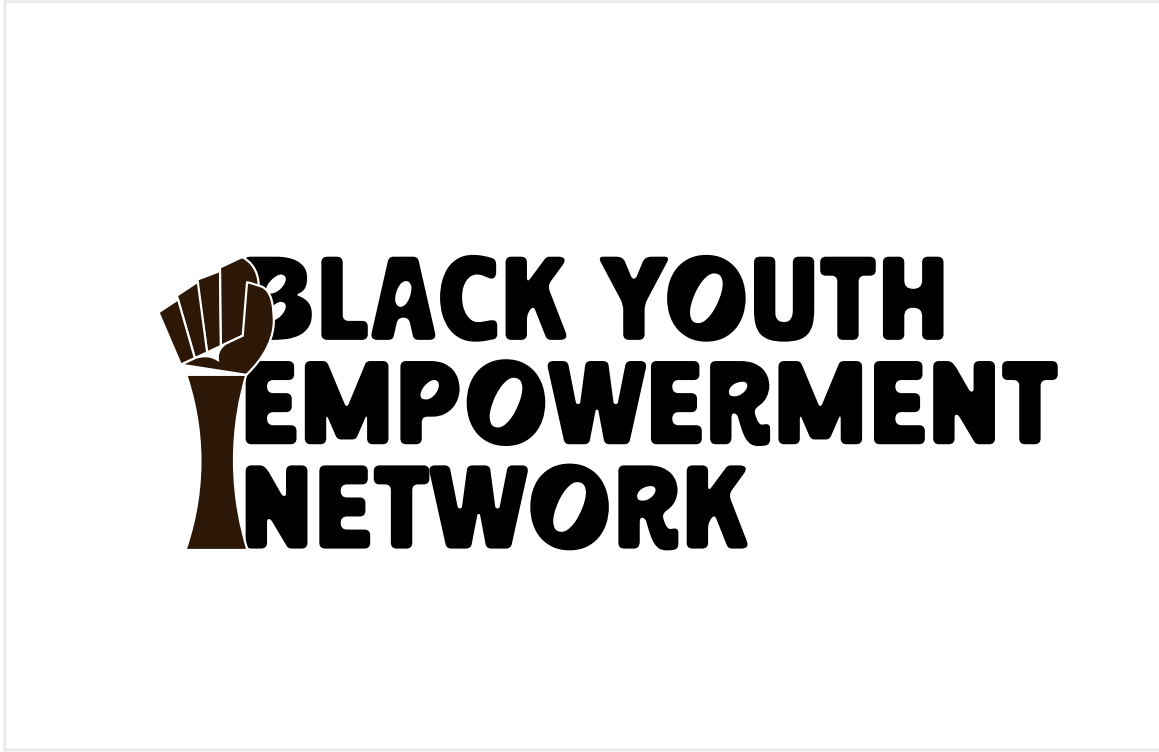
Do not place things behind / infront our logo



Do not flip our logo



Do not obstruct clearspace of our logo



3.5 Logo Colors

To ensure consistency and protect brand recognition, the logo should only appear in the approved colour variations outlined below. Using these combinations maintains clarity, contrast, and a cohesive brand presence across all applications.



3.6 Logo Lockups

Full Acronym + Name

The horizontal lockup is best suited to formal environments, providing a balanced, streamlined presentation.

- Website headers and navigation bars
- Email signatures
- Presentation title slides
- Social Media
- Poster and Flyers
- Written Materials
- Formal reports
- Donor Letters

Full Name

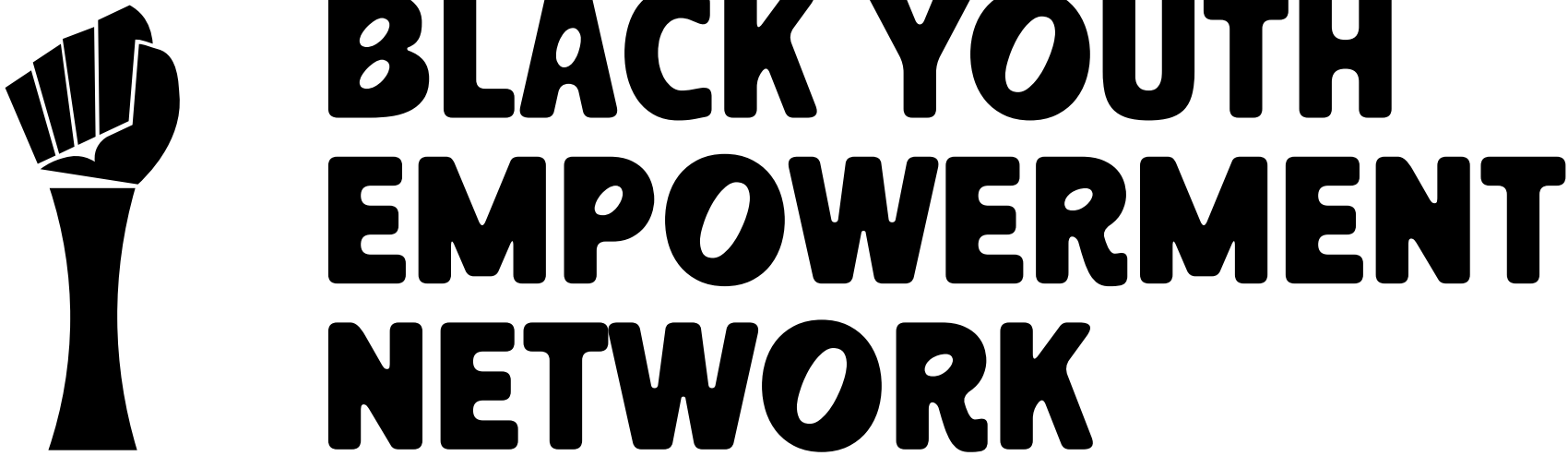
The Full Name lockup is recommended when horizontal space is restricted, allowing the brand to remain clear, legible, and visually consistent.

- Website headers and navigation bars
- Email signatures
- Presentation title slides
- Social Media
- Poster and Flyers
- Written MaterialsMobile-first digital placements
- Event signage and pull-up banners

Full Acronym + Name



Full Name



3.7 Co-Branding

Co-branding clearspace ensure that both logos in a partnership are displayed clearly and maintain their integrity.

The full brand lockup is recommended for co-branding. To define the clearspace between the logo partnerships, simply duplicate our clear space and place it next to our logo.



**BLACK YOUTH
EMPOWERMENT
NETWORK**



MOREHOUSE
COLLEGE



**BLACK YOUTH
EMPOWERMENT
NETWORK**



UNCF
A mind is a terrible
thing to waste®



**BLACK YOUTH
EMPOWERMENT
NETWORK**



MOREHOUSE
COLLEGE

3.8 University Chapters

University partnerships and expansions are expected to keep the core brand feel while adopting the colors of the branch school. Unless designated, the school colors are expected to be used in co-branding and naming ONLY. All additional partner assets with retain the core BYEN colors.

Refer to brand guidelines of partner school to determine proper color codes.

CHAPTER LOCKUP FORMAT



BYEN shorthand

University Name (omit 'University')

CHAPTER EXAMPLES



COLOR

4.1 Color Overview

Our brands colorpaletter establishes a cohesive and reconizableviusal indentity for BYEN. Consistent use of our specific colors helps evoke the right emotions, reinforces brand messagingm and enhances brand recall.

Our Primary colors are an earthy, grounded, skin tone and are used most often for the forefront of the brand. Our Secondary/Accent colors offer an electric jolt of energy and excitement, and personality to the brand. Please use the Secondary colors oftne in junction with our primary colours.

To ensure consistency across all applications, always follow the specifications provided: use RGB or HEX values for digital and on-screen content and PMS or CMYK values for print.

- Make sure to use proper color values for specific uses and do not guess at color values or change the percentages.
- Use colors from the primary coltro paletter as the main colors in a design.
- Use colors from the secondary color paletter for accents only.

Primary

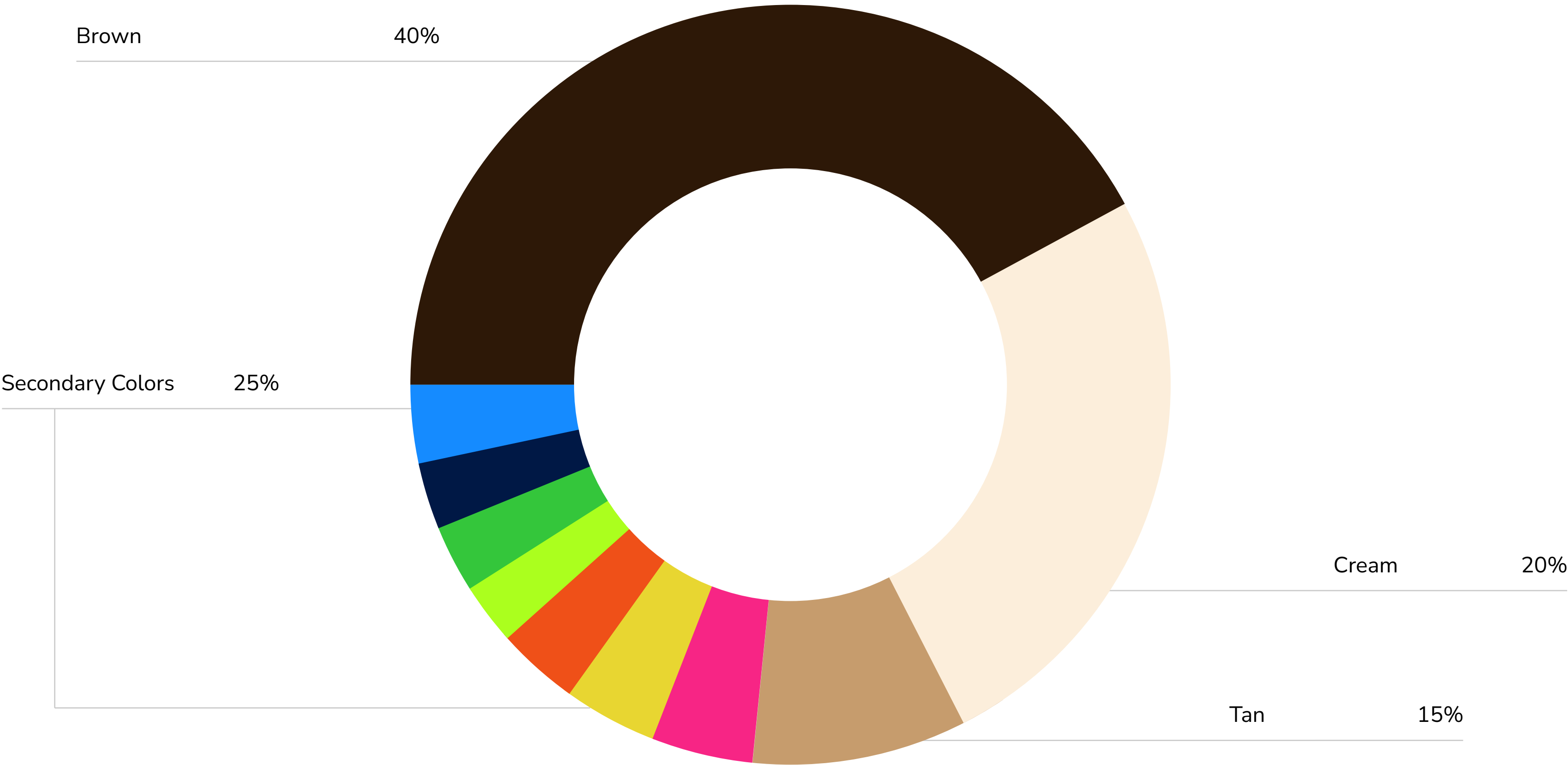
BROWN HEX: 2D1807 RGB: 45, 24, 7 CMYK: 54, 72, 78, 77	CREAM HEX: FCEEDB RGB: 252, 238, 219 CMYK: 0, 6, 1, 3, 0	TAN HEX: C69C6D RGB: 198, 156, 109 CMYK: 19, 41, 67, 1
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Secondary / Accent

CHILI RED HEX: EF5018 RGB: 239, 80, 24 CMYK: 0, 89, 100, 0	LIME HEX: ABFF1E RGB: 171, 255, 30 CMYK:45, 0, 100, 0	OCEAN BLUE HEX: 158BFF RGB: 21, 139, 255 CMYK: 78, 42, 0, 0
YELLOW HEX: E8D631 RGB: 232, 214, 49 CMYK: 11, 9, 100, 0	GREEN HEX: 34C63B RGB: 52, 198, 59 CMYK: 82, 0, 100, 0	DARK BLUE HEX: 001845 RGB: 0, 24,69 CMYK: 100, 91, 35, 49
PINK HEX: F27585 RGB: 247, 37, 133 CMYK: 0, 99, 8, 0		

4.2 Color Hierarchy

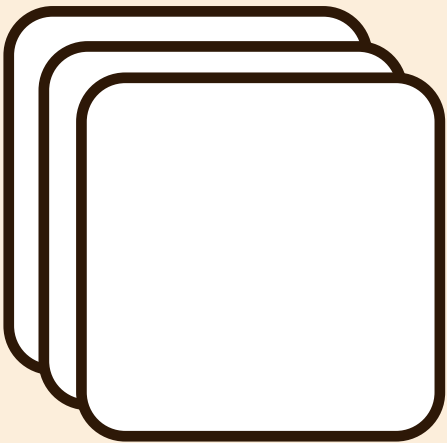
This shows the color distribution. Our primary colors Brown, Cream, and Tan will share ~75% of the canvas. The remaining 15% are shared by the Secondary/Accent colors that offer a splash of personality.



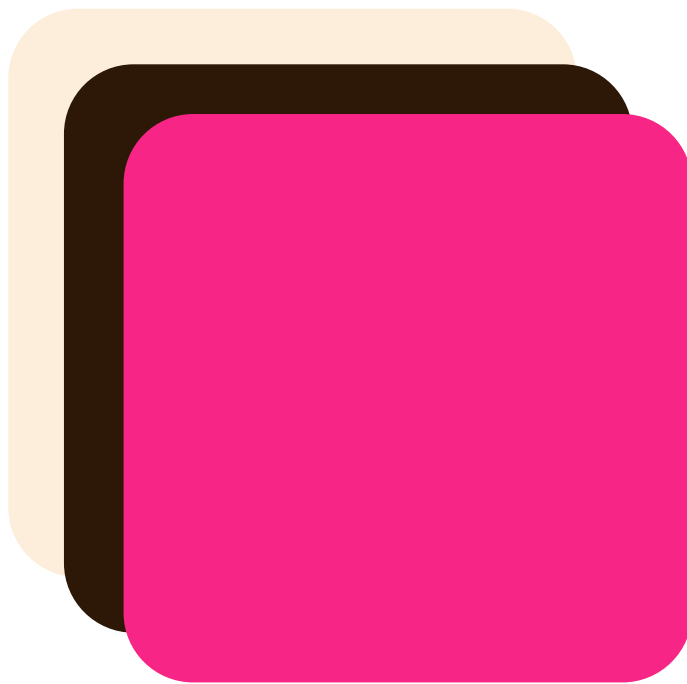
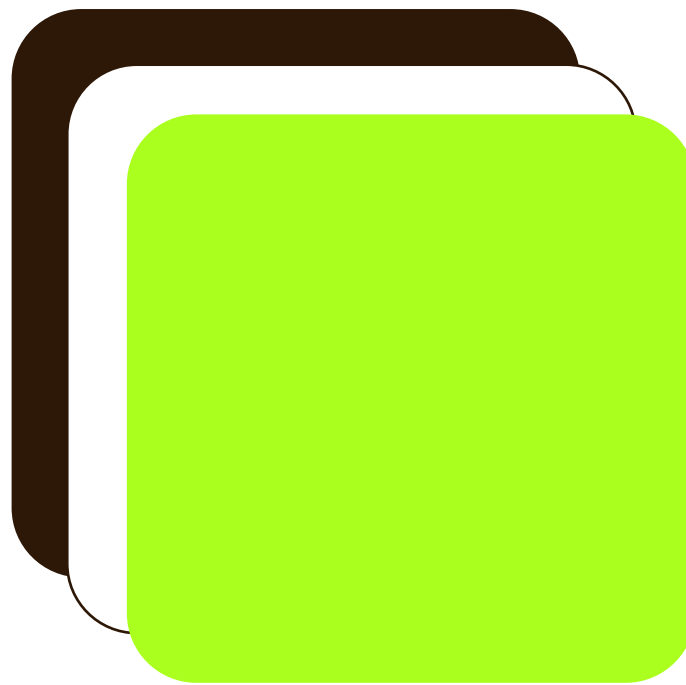
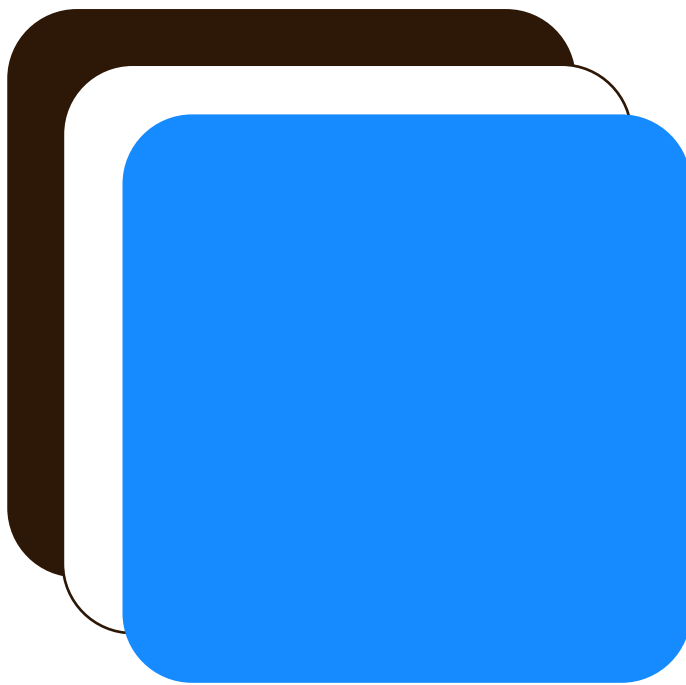
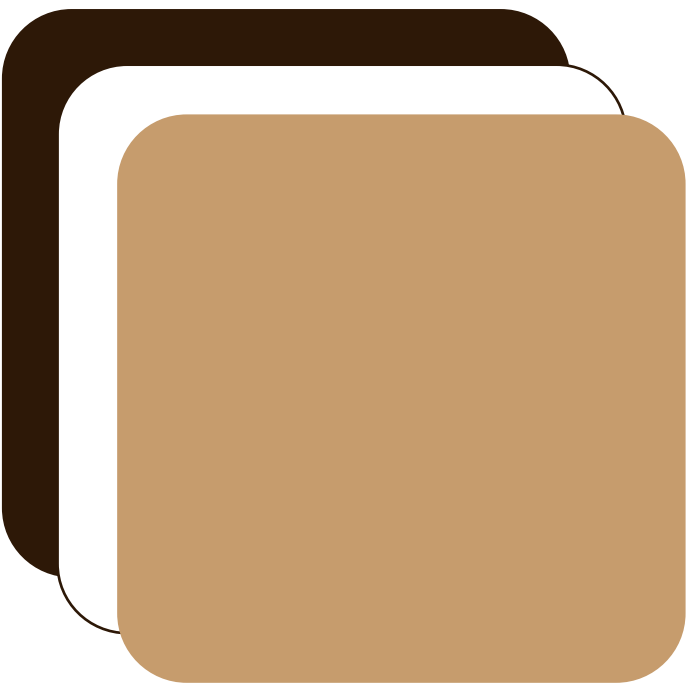
4.3 Color Schemes

Here are some examples of suggested color schemes you can use when creating graphics, soical media content, marketing materials or posters for BYEN.

Refer back to the Color Pairings page if you're not sure on what colors work and don't work.



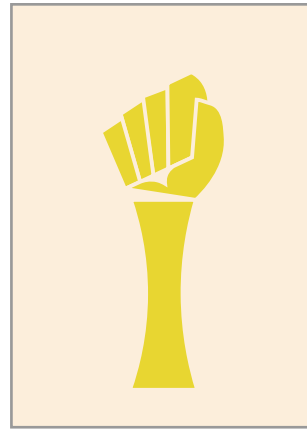
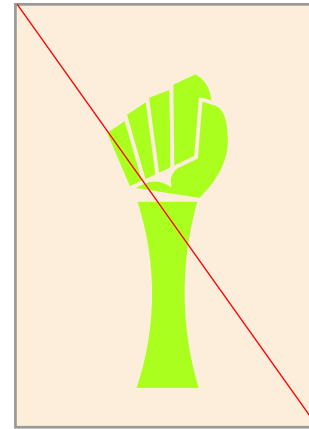
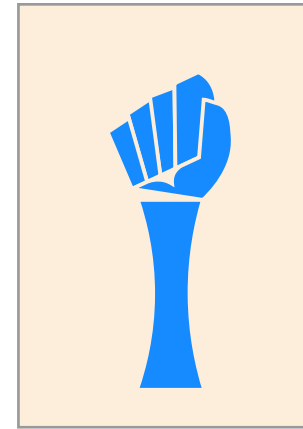
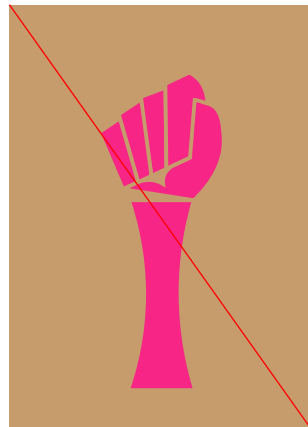
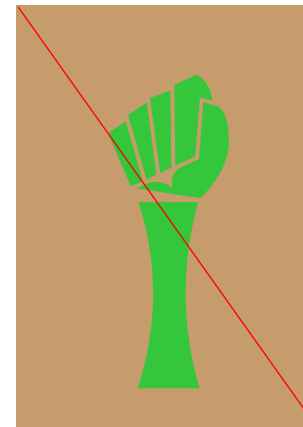
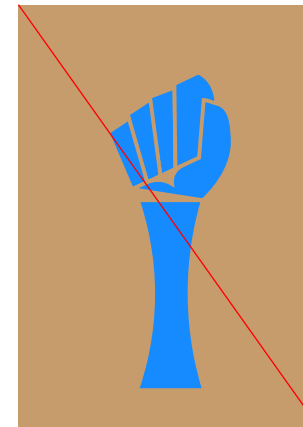
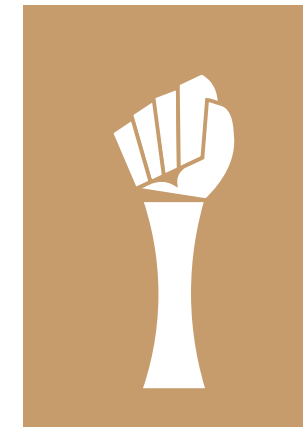
Background Color
Typography Color
Decorative Color



4.4 Color Pairings (Brown)

These examples show approved colour pairings designed to maintain strong contrast, support accessibility, and ensure visual consistency across Aspen communications.

The main square represents the background colour, the “Aa” shows the recommended text colour, and the smaller rectangle highlights suitable accent colours for graphics or UI elements.

BROWN/WHITE									
CREAM/WHITE									
TAN/WHITE									

4.5 Color Pairings (Other)

These examples show approved colour pairings designed to maintain strong contrast, support accessibility, and ensure visual consistency across Aspen communications.

The main square represents the background colour, the “Aa” shows the recommended text colour, and the smaller rectangle highlights suitable accent colours for graphics or UI elements.

WHITE/COLOR									
COLOR?WHITE									
COLOR/BLACK									
BLACK/COLOR									
BLUE/COLOR									

TYPOGRAPHY

5.1 Primary Type

Froople is BYEN’s primary typeface, used across key brand communications to create a distinctive and recognisable voice. As a bold, whimsical display font, it brings a confident, contemporary character that aligns with BYEN's positioning as a youth-driven brand.

Froople

Froople

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
1234567890

5.2 Secondary Type

Geist and Geist Mono support Aspen’s primary display typography by providing a clear, highly functional system for body copy and interface elements. Together, they balance readability with a subtle technical character that reinforces the brand.

Roles & Usage

Body 1 — Nunito Sans Regular
Used for primary body copy and longer text sections where readability is critical.

Body 2 — Nunito Sans Black
Used for shorter supporting bold CTAs or socially engaging slides.

Labels & Callouts — Nunito Sans Semibold/Bold
Ideal for UI labels, metadata, captions, and callouts where a structured, technical tone is beneficial.

Weights

Nunito San Bold
Used for light backgrounds.

Nunito San Light/Regular
Used for dark backgrounds

Typeface Name

Nunito Sans

Weight

Nunito Sans Light

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee0123456789*!@£\$^&>?:”

Nunito Sans Medium

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee0123456789*!@£\$^&>?:”

Nunito Sans Semibold

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee 0123456789*!@£\$^&>?:”

Nunito Sans Bold

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee0123456789*!@£\$^&>?:”

Nunito Sans Black

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee0123456789*!@£\$^&>?:”

5.3 Type Relationship

H1 — Primary Headlines

H1 uses Froople in either all uppercase or in mixed case (depending on the callout) to deliver maximum impact. This style is reserved for key brand statements, campaign headlines, and moments where strong attention is required.

Make sure to apply correct type settings

H2 — Section Headlines

H2 uses Nunito Sans Bold in sentence case to balance prominence with readability. This level supports primary messaging and introduces major sections of content.

Make sure to apply correct type settings

H3 — Body Copy

H3 uses Nunito Sans Regular in sentence case for smaller headings and supporting structure. This creates hierarchy without competing with higher-level messaging.

Make sure to apply correct type settings

Headings (Clash Display Medium)

What Does it Mean to Have Access?

Type Settings

Letter Spacing: 0%
Line Height: 100%

Sub-Headings (Clash Display Regular)

Access extends past the classroom.

Letter Spacing:
Line Height: 100%

Body Copy (Geist Regular)

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur. Excepteur sint occaecat cupidatat non proident, sunt in culpa qui officia deserunt mollit anim id est laborum.

Letter Spacing:
Line Height: 100%

Labels / Buttons (Geist Mono Light)

FIND OUT MORE

Letter Spacing:
Line Height: 100%

5.4 Type Settings

This page demonstrates the correct typographic spacing for Aspen’s heading and body styles, highlighting the importance of balanced leading and consistent settings. When applied correctly, typography feels clear, structured, and easy to read, preserving hierarchy and visual rhythm. Spacing that is too tight reduces legibility and creates visual tension, while spacing that is too loose weakens cohesion and impact. Following the defined type settings ensures a consistent, polished expression of the Aspen brand across all applications.

OUR

Too tight 

Heading
Example goes
here, yes here.

Too tight 

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur. Excepteur sint occaecat cupidatat non proident, sunt in culpa qui officia deserunt mollit anim id est laborum.

Just Right 

Heading
Example goes
here, yes here.

Just Right 

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur. Excepteur sint occaecat cupidatat non proident, sunt in culpa qui officia deserunt mollit anim id est laborum.

Too loose 

Heading
Example goes
here, yes here.

Too loose 

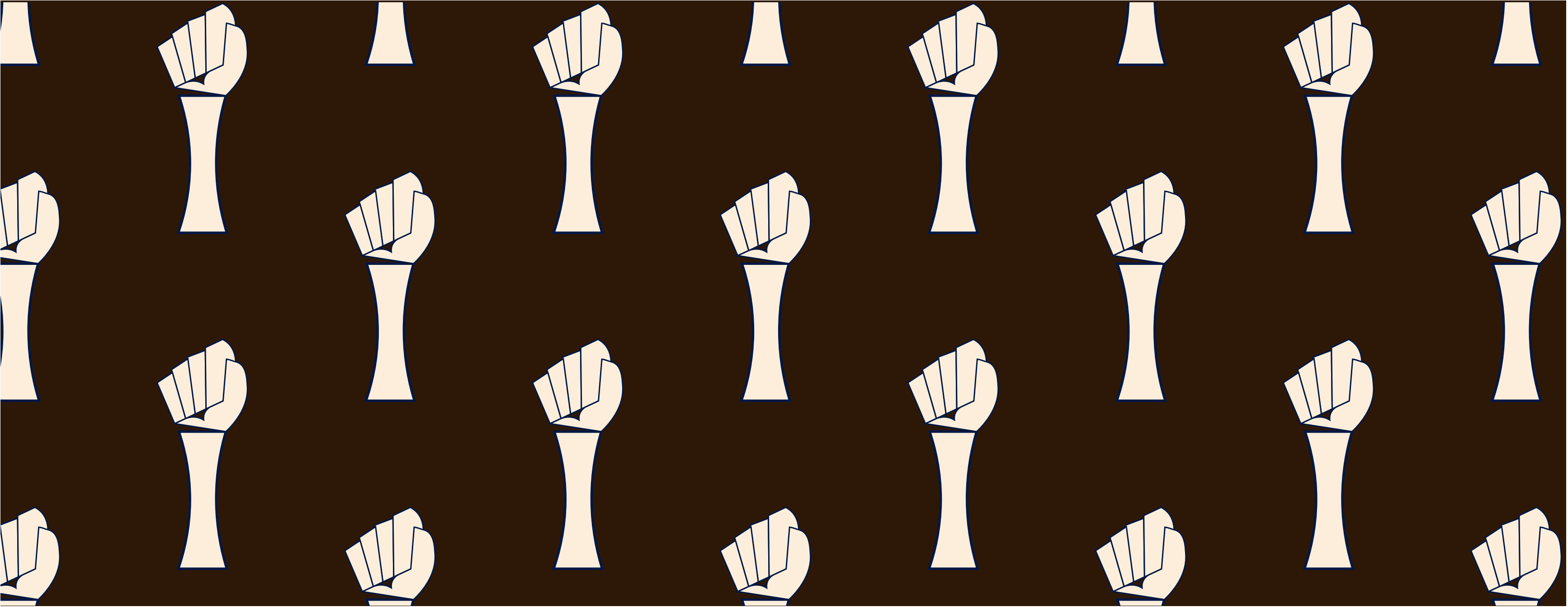
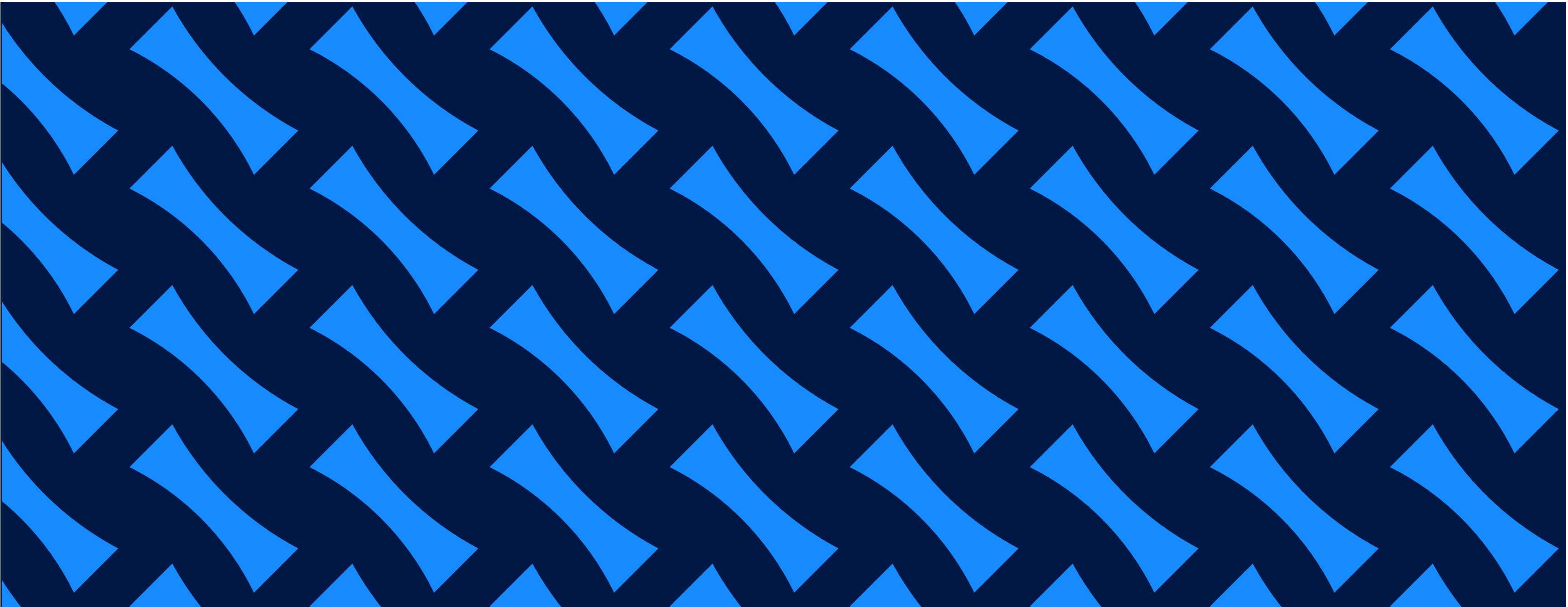
Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit, sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur. Excepteur sint occaecat cupidatat non proident, sunt in culpa qui officia deserunt mollit anim id est laborum.

DESIGN

6.1 Brand Pattern

BYEN’s brand patterns extend the visual language beyond core identity elements, providing flexible background treatments that add depth, texture, and recognisability. Derived from the geometry and shapes within the logo, these patterns reinforce the brand while remaining subtle enough to support content.

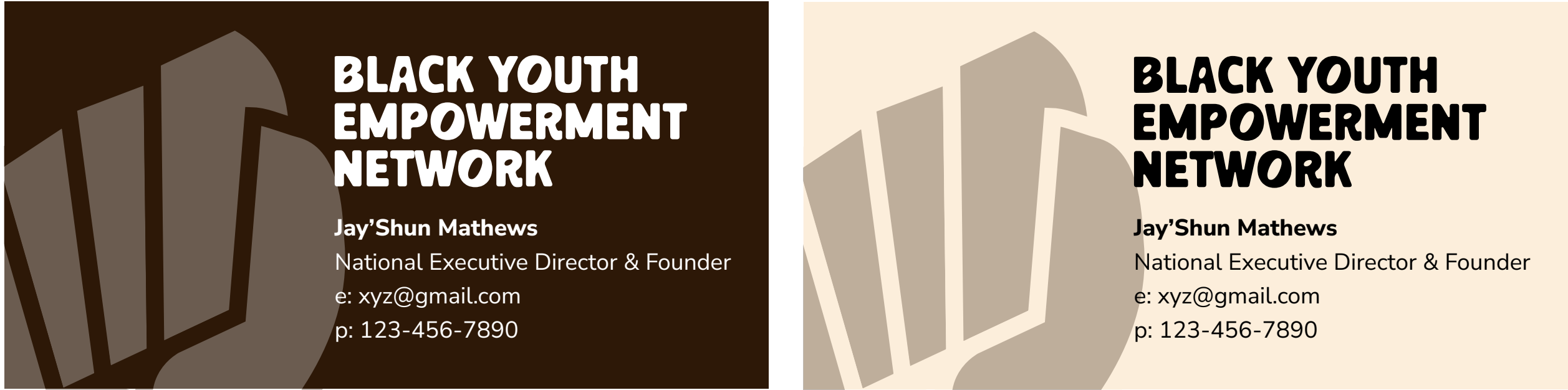
They are used selectively across digital and marketing applications to create visual interest, frame layouts, and strengthen brand presence without overpowering messaging. Patterns should function as supportive surfaces — enhancing hierarchy, guiding the eye, and adding a distinctive layer to the overall design system.



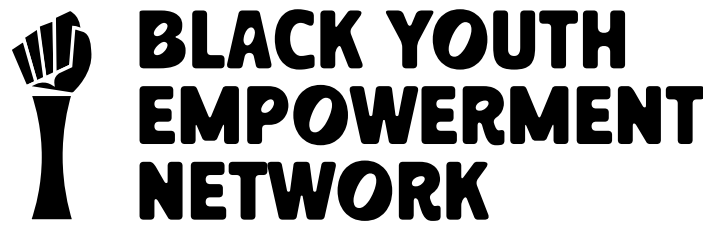
BRAND ASSETS

7.1 Print

Business Cards



Written Material



Black Youth Empowerment Network
1234 Main Street
Atlanta, GA 12345
United States
p: 123-456-7890

To Whom It May Concern:

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur. Excepteur sint occaecat cupidatat non proident, sunt in culpa qui officia deserunt mollit anim id est laborum. Sed ut perspiciatis unde omnis iste natus error sit voluptatem accusantium doloremque laudantium, totam rem aperiam, eaque ipsa quae ab illo inventore veritatis et quasi architecto beatae vitae dicta sunt explicabo. Nemo enim ipsam

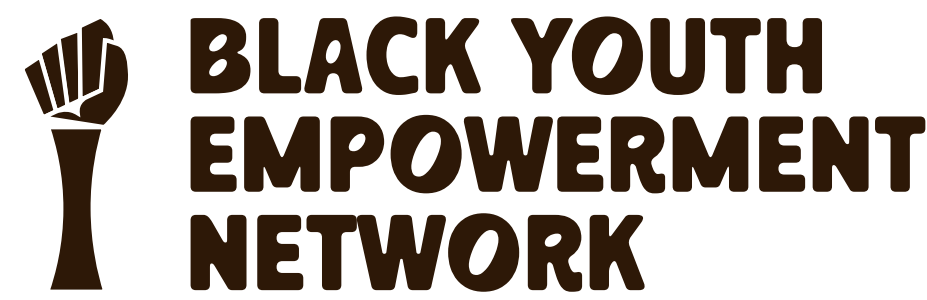
voluptatem quia voluptas sit aspernatur aut odit aut fugit, sed quia consequuntur magni dolores eos qui ratione voluptatem sequi nesciunt. Neque porro quisquam est, qui dolorem ipsum quia dolor sit amet, consectetur, adipisci velit, sed quia non numquam eius modi tempora incidunt ut labore et dolore magnam aliquam quaerat voluptatem. Here's a longer Lorem Ipsum paragraph you can use for your branding document layout/typography samples: Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis aut

e irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur. Excepteur sint occaecat cupidatat non proident, sunt in culpa qui

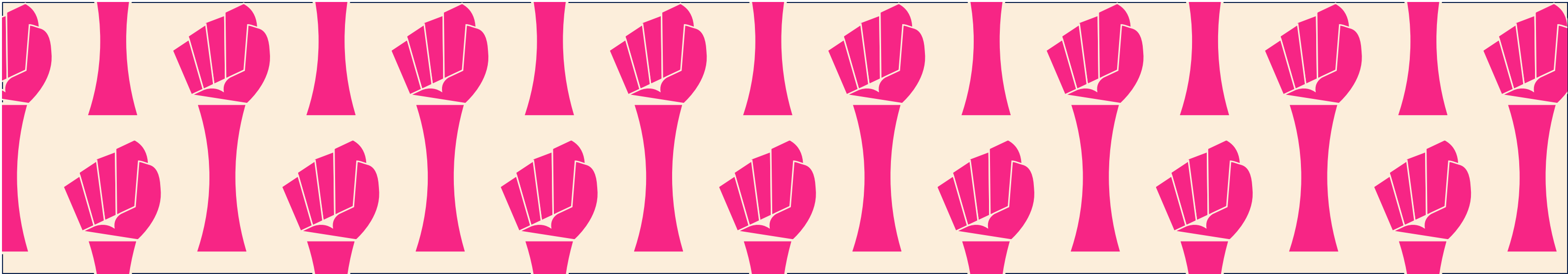
7.2 Email



Jay’Shun Mathews
National Executive Director & Founder
e: xyz@gmail.com
p: 123-456-7890



Jay’Shun Mathews
National Executive Director & Founder
e: xyz@gmail.com
p: 123-456-7890

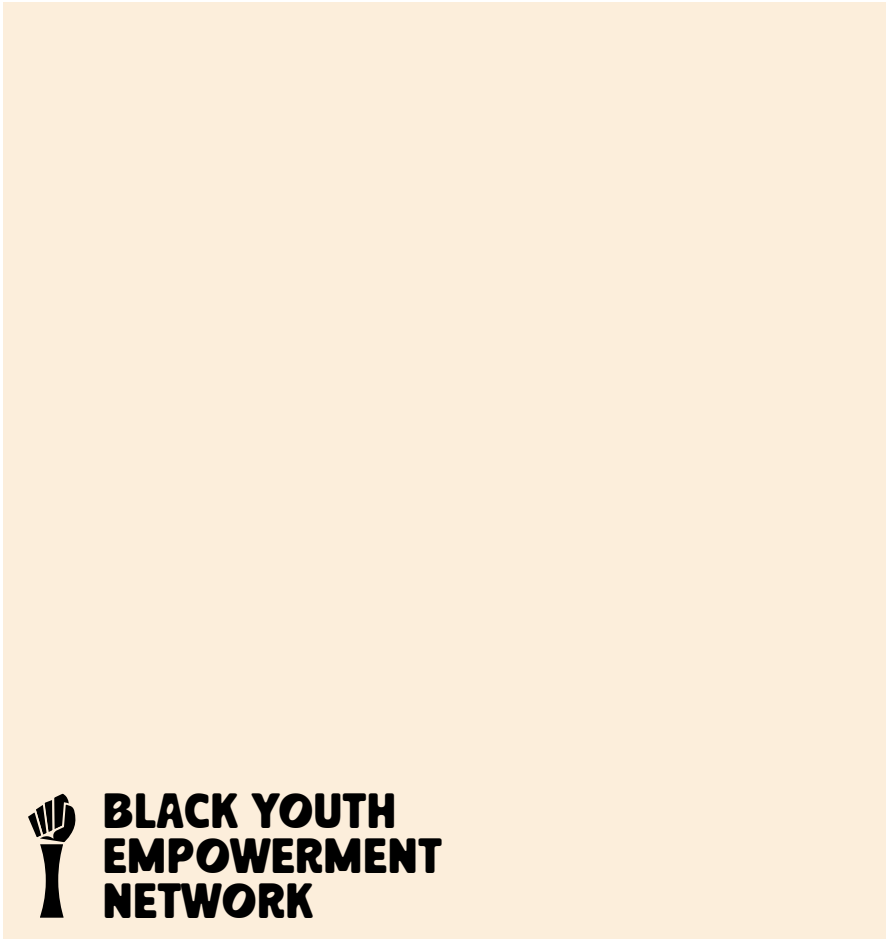
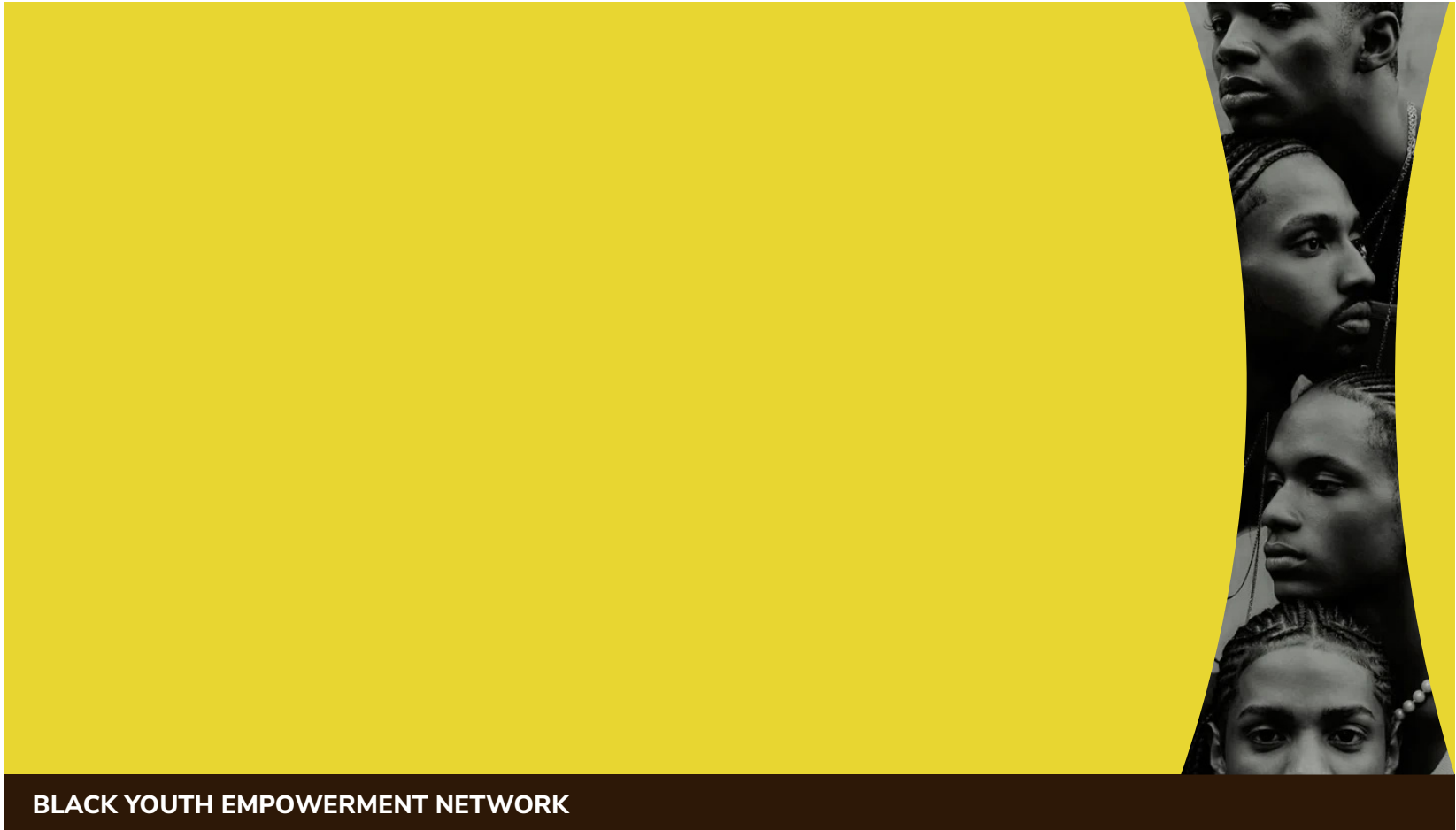


To Whom It May Concern:

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco laboris nisi ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis aute irure dolor in reprehenderit in voluptate velit esse cillum dolore eu fugiat nulla pariatur. Excepteur sint occaecat cupidatat non proident, sunt in culpa qui officia deserunt mollit anim id est laborum. Sed ut perspiciatis unde omnis iste natus error sit voluptatem accusantium doloremque laudantium, totam rem aperiam, eaque ipsa quae ab illo inventore veritatis et quasi architecto beatae vitae dicta sunt explicabo. Nemo enim ipsam

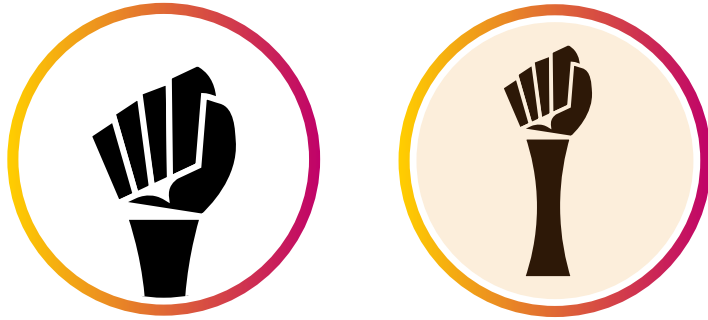
voluptatem quia voluptas sit aspernatur aut odit aut fugit, sed quia consequuntur magni dolores eos qui ratione voluptatem sequi nesciunt. Neque porro quisquam est, qui dolorem ipsum quia dolor sit amet, consectetur, adipisci velit, sed quia non numquam eius modi tempora incidunt ut labore et dolore magnam aliquam quaerat voluptatem. Here’s a longer Lorem Ipsum paragraph you can use for your branding document layout/typography samples:

7.3 Presentation

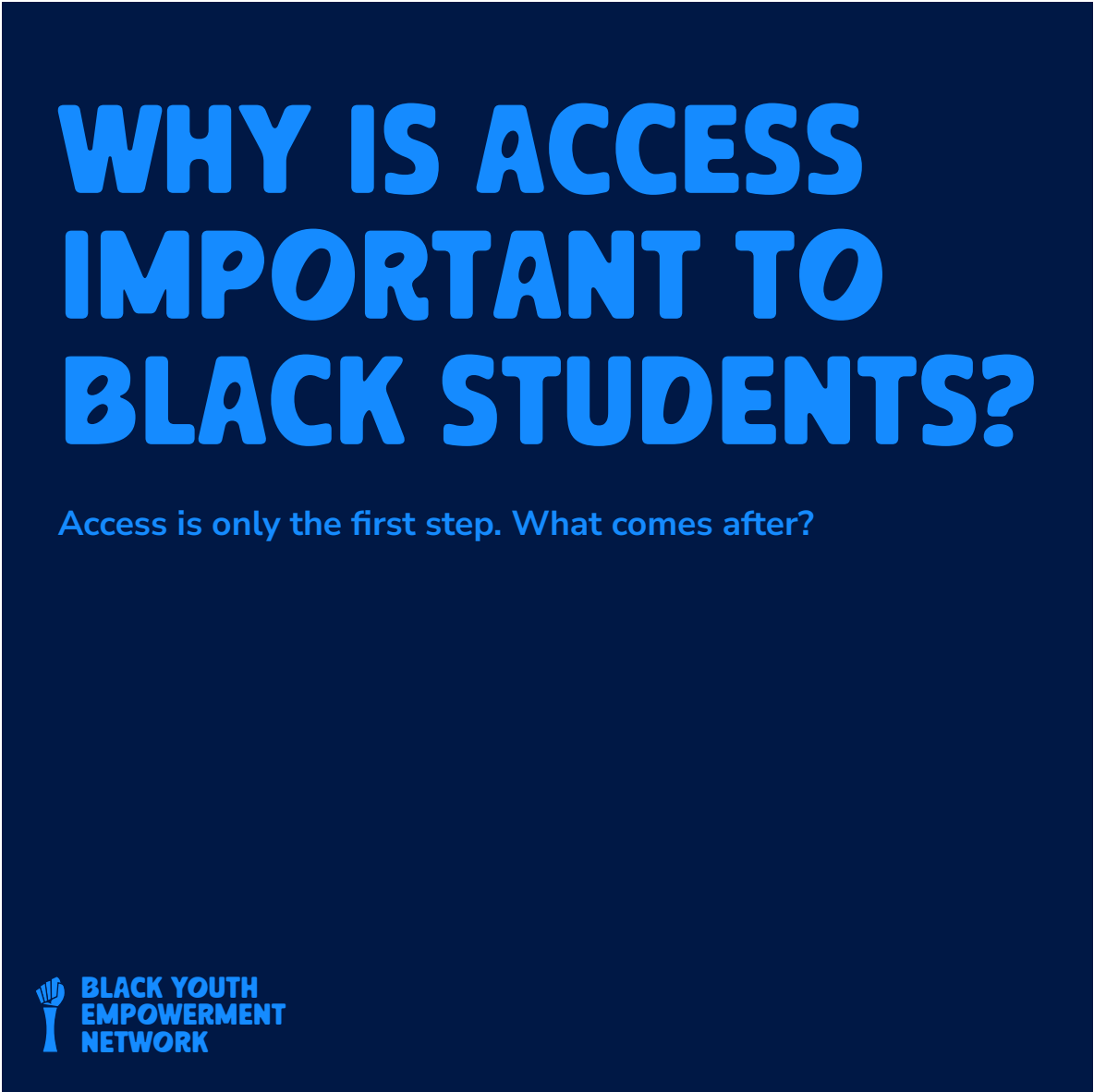


7.4 Social

Instagram Profile



Social Posts



LinkedIn Header









Thank you

Contact

That's everything you need to confidently apply the BYEN brand. These guidelines are designed to create consistency while allowing flexibility across different formats, platforms, and creative executions.

If you have any questions, need additional assets, or would like guidance on applying the brand in a specific context, please reach out to the studio or BYEN leadership.

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